THE CALL

Northwest College — Worland Center

Kristy Hansen · (307) 347-8541 · she is there 3 to 7 p.m., Monday through Thursday

What you are actually after

Not a yes. A name. You are finding out who decides whether the college runs a new short course. Kristy staffs the front of that office — registration, advising, pointing people toward things. She almost certainly does not approve courses, but she knows who does. A ten-minute call that ends with a name and an email address is a complete success. Stop there.

The one word that puts you in the right queue

Non-credit. Colleges run two separate tracks. *Credit* classes are academic, carry college credit, and go through a curriculum committee — slow, and not what you want. *Non-credit* — also called community education or workforce training — is short courses, no grades, no credit. That is where the QuickBooks and eBay classes live, and it is run by the **Center for Training and Development**. If "CTD" does not land, say "the training and development side."

How to open

> *"Hello, my name is Walter Wilkinson, I live here in Worland. I'd like to ask about teaching a short non-credit course through the Center for Training and Development — the sort of thing you've run on QuickBooks or selling on eBay. Is that something the college takes proposals for, and who should I be talking to?"*

If she asks what the course is

> *"Using AI to build a small website about one subject — a local business, a county office, a club. Three or four sessions, hands-on. People leave with a site that is actually live on the internet."*

Keep it to that. Do not say "I've invented a method" — it invites questions you do not want to answer standing at a phone. Concrete beats impressive.

The three things to come away with

1. Does the college take course proposals from people in the community?
2. Who decides — a name, a title, an email or a direct number.
3. Is there a calendar? Do courses start on a term, or whenever enough people sign up?

If she does not know

That is a fine answer and it is still a win. "No problem at all — is there somebody in Powell on the training and development side I could ask?" Then get the name and write it down before you hang up.

What NOT to raise

Nothing about grants, sponsorship, the Business Council or a 501(c)(3). Different conversation, different person, and raising it now makes you sound like you want money rather than to teach. That conversation becomes possible once a course exists — and it is far easier then, because by that point they have already worked with you.

Worth knowing before you dial

The Worland Center already runs exactly this kind of thing: digital photography, selling on eBay, entrepreneurship, QuickBooks, Word, Excel. You are not asking them to do something new in kind — only a new subject. That is a much smaller request than it feels like from your side of it.

Write down: who you spoke to · the name they gave you · email or phone · anything said about timing